

KOH SAMUI

WHEN TO COME

Every month, honestly — weather, sea, crowds and what's on



12 months · 12 pages · no month written off
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THE SHORT ANSWER

There is no bad month on Koh Samui — there are months that suit different people. The island sits in the Gulf of Thailand, so it runs on a reversed monsoon: while the rest of Thailand is wet in summer, we're dry. Our rain arrives in October and November, and our roughest sea comes with it.

Which means the advice everyone repeats — "go to Thailand in winter" — is only half right for Samui. December and January are beautiful and busy, but the sea is at its wildest. April and July are the two I'd book without thinking.

PICK BY WHAT MATTERS TO YOU

Good weather overall	February · March
Clearest water for swimming	June · July
Best value for the weather you get	April · May
Emptiest beaches, lowest prices	September · October
Festivals and atmosphere	April (Songkran) · November (Loy Krathong)
Fruit season at its peak	May (durian) · August (mangosteen)
Christmas & New Year	Late December · January
Months to think twice about	November · early December



JANUARY

High season, big sea



- New Year vibes
- Impressive waves

January is the island at full volume. The New Year fireworks on the beach are the best night of the year here, and the crowd stays through the whole month. The rain from December is still clearing out, so you get bright days broken by short heavy showers — and the sea is still working off the northeast monsoon. On the east coast the waves are genuinely impressive: worth watching, not always worth swimming in. West coast is calm.

Air	29–30 °C, sunny spells between showers
Sea	~28 °C but rough on the east
Rain	Tapering off after December — expect a few grey days
Crowds	Peak. Highest prices of the year

COME FOR New Year, big-swell photography, guaranteed atmosphere

SKIP IT IF You're looking for a quiet trip on a budget